Phase 1 – Brainstorming & Ideation

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

1. Introduction

Information Technology (IT) procurement is the process of requesting, approving, purchasing, and delivering IT equipment such as laptops, desktops, monitors, and accessories. In many organizations, laptop requests are handled manually through emails, paper forms, or spreadsheets. This manual process consumes time, creates communication gaps, and increases the possibility of errors. This project focuses on automating the standard laptop ordering process using ServiceNow Flow Designer, which creates automated workflows without complex coding.

2. Problem Identification

The existing manual procurement system has several challenges: delays in approval, manual entry of employee details, difficulty tracking request status, duplicate requests, and poor communication between employees, managers, and procurement teams. These issues reduce productivity and increase procurement time.

3. Problem Statement

Organizations require a simple and efficient system that automates the complete laptop procurement workflow. The system should accept employee requests, send them for manager approval, create procurement tasks automatically, notify stakeholders, and maintain proper records.

4. Brainstorming and Idea Generation

Different automation ideas were analyzed. ServiceNow Flow Designer was selected because it provides approval workflows, notifications, catalog tasks, and automation features without extensive programming.

5. Proposed Solution

Employees submit a laptop request through the Service Catalog. The request is sent to the manager for approval. After approval, Flow Designer automatically creates procurement tasks, sends notifications, and updates the request status until delivery.

6. Project Objectives

• Automate laptop ordering. • Reduce manual work. • Speed up manager approval. • Improve transparency and tracking. • Maintain accurate procurement records.

7. Project Scope

The project covers employee laptop requests, approval workflow, procurement task creation, notifications, request tracking, and status updates for standard laptop orders within an organization.

8. Target Users

Employees, Managers, IT Procurement Team, and System Administrator use the system for different stages of the workflow.

9. Expected Outcomes

The automated system reduces processing time, minimizes human errors, improves communication, provides real-time request tracking, and increases efficiency in IT procurement.

10. Conclusion

Brainstorming and Ideation is the foundation of this project. After identifying problems in manual laptop procurement, the project proposes an automated workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer to make laptop procurement faster, more accurate, and more transparent.